

Φερεκύδης ὁ Σύριος

Pherecydes of Syros on Cosmology and Prose Origins

eul_aid: bcw

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Μικτὰι διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Presocratic](#)

Pherecydes of Syros was an early Greek thinker from the 6th century BCE. He is considered one of the first writers to compose in prose instead of poetry, marking a transition in how ideas were expressed. Ancient sources often describe him as a teacher of Pythagoras, though the historical truth of this connection is uncertain.

He wrote on the origins of the gods and the cosmos, in a work sometimes called the **Heptamychos** ("Seven Recesses"). His writings survive only in fragments quoted by later authors. In his cosmogony, he used innovative mythological figures like Zas (a form of Zeus), Chthonie (Earth), and Chronos (Time) to explain how the world was ordered.

According to modern scholars, Pherecydes holds a significant place as a forerunner to Presocratic philosophy. While his work used myth, it was a systematic attempt to explain the world's origins, influencing later philosophical and religious traditions. He is remembered as an important bridge between earlier poetic mythology and the rise of rational inquiry in ancient Greece.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Κοσμολογίας · [Fragments on Cosmology](#) · 16 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 14 passages

Other Presocratic Authors

- Ἀλκμαίων ὁ Κροτωνιάτης · [Alcmaeon of Croton](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξαγόρας ὁ Κλαζομένιος · [Anaxagoras of Clazomenae](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμανδρος ὁ Μιλήσιος · [Anaximander of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμενης ὁ Μιλήσιος · [Anaximenes of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξιμένους τοῦ Μιλήσιου Ἐπιστολαί (Ψευδο-Ἀναξίμενης) · [Anaximenes-pseudo Miletus Letters](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρχέλαος ὁ Μιλήσιος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · [Archelaus of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Κλεόβουλος ὁ Λίνδιος · [Cleobulus of Lindos I](#) · 1 work
- Δημόκριτος ὁ Ἀβδηρίτης · [Democritus of Abdera](#) · 2 works
- Διογένης ὁ Ἀπολλωνιάτης · [Diogenes of Apollonia](#) · 2 works
- Ἐμπεδοκλῆς ὁ Ἀκραγαντίνος · [Empedocles of Acragas](#) · 3 works

- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus · 2 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus II · 1 work